WEEKLY MARKETS SUMMARY

Week of October 12–16, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · October 2026

NASDAQ 100 — WEEKLY CHG.

−5.49%

30,883 → 29,188 pts | largest index decline

S&P 500 — WEEKLY CHG.

−1.95%

7,811 → 7,659 pts | four down days out of five

VIX — WEEKLY CHG.

+34.7%

14.84 → 19.99 | Friday close at 19.99

WTI (FUT.) — WEEKLY CHG.

+7.83%

$91.85 → $99.04 | Middle East tension

The week marked a shift in the market's dominant fear: from inflation to its effect on demand and credit. Hotter-than-expected US CPI and PPI pushed the 10-year yield to 5.32% before it pulled back, but the heavy blow came from semiconductors and AI infrastructure: the Nasdaq 100 fell 5.5% and chips logged eight straight down sessions, with CoreWeave losing about 25% on the week. The VIX jumped 35% and oil gained almost 8% on escalating Houthi attacks and doubts over Iran ahead of the November 3 elections. In Argentina, the Merval held up (+0.7%), but dollar sovereigns slipped 1.4%–1.8% and the EMBI moved above 620 bps.

1. Timeline of the Week

WEEKLY TIMELINE	
Mon 10/12	Columbus Day holiday: US bond market shut and Argentina closed. Trump said there would be no attack on Iran before the November 3 elections, while Houthis struck Riyadh airport (12 dead). An unconfirmed Russia–Ukraine "energy truce" circulated. Fed's Hammack argued rates should rise above 3.75%–4%. Argentina's 2027 Budget debate began in the lower house. October Michigan sentiment: 46.3; 1-year inflation expectations: 4.7%. S&P 500: 7,807.24.
Tue 10/13	Chips collapsed on CXMT news (Samsung and SK Hynix nearly −10%). The IMF warned on bond yields and projected 3.1% global growth. SoftBank sold US$11 billion of high-yield bonds; the Firmus IPO failed and AirTrunk postponed. Caputo traveled to Thailand for the IMF's third review (US$869 million). Argentina's September CPI came in at 1.9% m/m and 33.5% y/y. Big banks opened earnings season. EMBI: 597 bps. S&P 500: 7,805.45.
Wed 10/14	US September CPI: 3.7% y/y (est. 3.6%) and core 2.6% y/y; the 10-year touched 5.32% and closed near 5.11%. S&P 500 −1.1% with semiconductors −4.5%. In the following Asian session, the Kospi fell 8% (trading halted) and the Nikkei 5%. Houthis hit Aramco's headquarters. Comments from Daly, Bowman and Goolsbee. EMBI: 611 bps. S&P 500: 7,718.94.
Thu 10/15	September PPI: +1.3% m/m and 6.3% y/y (est. 5.3%), with core at 5.0% y/y. The Dow rose 1.08%. CoreWeave rebounded 5.94% after a Huang comment, though its CDS topped 1,000 bps. Warsh spoke overnight with no hints. The probability of a hike at the October 27–28 FOMC fell below 15%, with the risk pushed to December. Industrial production +0.7% m/m; Philly Fed 20.9; Empire State 25.5. EMBI: 622 bps. S&P 500: 7,744.06.
Fri 10/16	Nasdaq 100 −2.50%, S&P 500 −1.09% and Dow −0.34%. Chips fell for an eighth straight session (SOX −3.83%): CoreWeave −11.91% (−25% on the week; debt above US$51 billion and bonds yielding over 15%), Nebius −12%, AMD and Intel −6%. The VIX rose 21.5% to 19.99 and the Russell 2000 fell 1.7%; Treasuries barely moved while energy and defense advanced. Import prices +1.1% m/m. The IEA will release 20 million barrels of diesel (vs. 50 million expected) and the US is weighing easing shadow-fleet sanctions. In Argentina, the government paused local dollar-bond issuance; MSCI will replace the S&P Merval from 10/19. Datafolha for Brazil's runoff: Flávio 47%, Lula 45%.

2. Weekly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 10/9. Reference close: Friday 10/16.

Asset	Close Fri 10/9	Close Fri 10/16	Weekly chg.
S&P 500	7,811.54	7,659.44	−1.95%
Nasdaq 100	30,883.15	29,187.55	−5.49%
Dow Jones	51,654.95	52,002.41	+0.67%
VIX	14.84	19.99	+34.70%
UST 10Y	5.24%	5.10%	−15 bps
WTI (futures)	$91.85	$99.04	+7.83%
Gold (futures)	$4,216.30	$4,186.70	−0.70%
Bitcoin	$82,546.32	$81,680.48	−1.05%
EMBI Global (Argentina)	589 bps	622 bps*	+33 bps

Argentina local market	Close Fri 10/9	Close Fri 10/16	Weekly chg.
GD30D	$0.5767	$0.5688	−1.37%
GD35D	$0.7552	$0.7418	−1.77%
S&P Merval (pesos)	2,828,027.00	2,848,945.00	+0.74%
S&P Merval (USD MEP)	1,837.24	1,853.90	+0.91%
USD MEP (AL30)	$1,539.28	$1,536.73	−0.17%

** Argentina's EMBI reflects the last confirmed official close (Thursday 10/15); JP Morgan publishes with a lag. GD30D, GD35D and AL30/AL30D verified on Balanz Productores at the Friday 10/16 close; Friday 10/9 prices are derived from the reported weekly change. USD MEP = AL30 / AL30D; Merval in USD = Merval in pesos / MEP. WTI and gold are futures contracts.*

3. Key Drivers of the Week

KEY DRIVERS	
Hotter US inflation than expected, but the market is now watching demand and credit	September CPI (3.7% y/y, core 2.6%) and especially PPI (+1.3% m/m, 6.3% y/y, core 5.0%) beat estimates, while import (+1.1%) and export (+2.2%) prices confirmed energy-driven cost pressure. The 10-year touched 5.32% on Wednesday and ended the week at 5.10% with no clear trend. What matters is that the market stopped prioritizing rate hikes (probability of a move at the October 27–28 FOMC below 15%, with the risk pushed to December) and began pricing the hit to consumption and credit: the high-yield spread widened about 40 bps in a month and the NY Fed services index printed −20.7 (est. −9).
Break in semiconductors and AI infrastructure: credit becomes the weak point	The Nasdaq 100 lost 5.5% and chips fell eight straight sessions (SOX −3.83% on Friday), while tech lost about 3.6% in five sessions versus +5.3% for health care. The CXMT news, the failed Firmus IPO, AirTrunk's postponement and SoftBank's US$11 billion junk-bond sale strained financing for the AI investment cycle. CoreWeave (−25% on the week; debt above US$51 billion, bonds yielding over 15% and CDS above 1,000 bps) is the thermometer: if the cost of capital keeps rising, the damage could spread across the chain. The VIX jumped 35% to 19.99, yet protection against extreme events remains expensive, a sign that traders do not rule out a larger move.
Oil nears US$100 on Middle East escalation and a limited IEA release	Houthi strikes on Riyadh airport and Aramco's headquarters, plus an Iran-escalation probability before 11/3 that Eurasia Group raised from 35% to 65%, pushed WTI to US$99.04 (+7.8%). The IEA announced a release of only 20 million barrels of diesel versus 50 million expected, and the US is weighing easing shadow-fleet sanctions, showing the tension between containing prices and keeping pressure on Russia and Iran. December 2027 Brent is up 13% since September.
Argentina: sovereigns under pressure, equities firm, and the government pauses dollar issuance	The EMBI went from 589 to 622 bps in four sessions, CDS remain elevated and dollar bonds slipped 1.4%–1.8% (GD30D −1.37%, GD35D −1.77%). The government paused local dollar-bond issuance while Caputo negotiates the IMF's third review in Thailand (US$869 million). September CPI (1.9% m/m, 33.5% y/y) was in line and the Merval gained 0.74% in pesos and 0.91% in dollars, with the MEP nearly flat (−0.17%). BCRA reserves exceed US$50 billion and the wholesale rate is around $1,513; from Monday 10/19 MSCI replaces the S&P Merval.

4. Signals to Watch — Week of October 19–23

SIGNALS TO WATCH	
MSCI replaces the S&P Merval from Monday 10/19	The index change may generate passive flows and liquidity moves in Argentine equities; watch Friday's closing volume, the composition of the new index and the relative behavior of ADRs.
US earnings season and AI-linked credit	Big banks have opened the season; now the focus shifts to AI capex guidance, margins and commentary on data-center financing. The key signal is the evolution of high-yield spreads, AI-issuer CDS and CoreWeave's bonds (yielding over 15%): further widening would point to funding stress.
Brazil: debates on 10/18 and 10/23, runoff on 10/25	Datafolha shows Flávio at 47% and Lula at 45%. A tight result could move the real and regional assets, with an indirect effect on Argentina.
Argentina: Treasury auction, IMF review and 2027 Budget	After the pause in dollar issuance, the peso auction will show refinancing conditions; meanwhile the IMF's third review (US$869 million disbursement) and the 2027 Budget debate in the lower house move forward. Country risk above 620 bps is the thermometer.
Macro and political calendar: FOMC, PCE and the 11/3 elections	The October 27–28 FOMC arrives with a hike probability below 15%; the UK Budget is on 10/28, PCE on 10/29 and Israel votes on 10/27. Iran escalation before the US midterms on 11/3 shapes oil and volatility.

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